propel ant consists essential y of three components: the oxidizer, the fuel and the additives. Solid propel ants are further classified into two types: composite and double base. The former consists of an oxidizer or inorganic material (like ammonium perchlorate) in a matrix of organic fuel (like synthetic rubber). Double base propel ants were distant dreams those days but nevertheless we dared to dream about them.

Al this self sufficiency and indigenous manufacture came gradual y, and not always without pain. We were a team of almost self-trained engineers. In retrospect I feel the unique blend of our untutored talent, character, and dedication suited SLV development the most. Problems surfaced regularly and almost consistently. But my team members never exhausted my patience. I recal writing after winding up a late night shift:

Beautiful hands are those that do
Work that is earnest and brave and true
Moment by moment
The long day through.

Almost paral el to our work on SLV, the DRDO was preparing itself for developing an indigenous surface-to-air